TA studio brief — Analysing curated spaces and audience impact

Pathway: SUMMIT · Week 4 Part 2 · Big question: How do curatorial choices — scale, lighting angle, sightlines, and framing — shape audience meaning in an exhibition?

TA practical setup & focus

Set up two safe low-voltage LED desk lamps or torches at the front studio bench so pupils can test flat vs raking light on their relief panels.

Studio kit: Week 3 structural relief panels, angle-poise lamps/torches for raking light tests, exhibition case-study cards, A3 Curatorial analysis boards, fineliners, tonal pencils

Key words to prompt

• raking light: A directional light source shone across a surface from a low side angle to throw every bump and recess into deep shadow.

• curatorial intent: The deliberate mood and visual journey a curator designs through spacing, height, and lighting.

• juxtaposition: Placing two artworks side by side so their scales, textures, or forms highlight each other.

• interpretation panel: The wall text and labels that frame the context and technical process for visitors.

• spatial hierarchy: Using central placement, breathing space, and spotlights to signal key focal works.

Supported route steps

1. Shine the table lamp from the front and then from the side across your relief panel to spot the deep shadows.

2. Skim chrome or white chalk along the top edges that caught the light.

3. Sketch where the light sits on your Curatorial plan sheet and tick the best wall spacing rule.

4. Write one sentence explaining how side light changes your panel.

Check: Raking light tested, directional highlights applied to panel, and curatorial sheet completed.

Review & exit support

Exit question: Why does 'raking light' (shone at a shallow angle across the surface) make a relief panel look far more dramatic than flat front lighting?

Staff note: Staff preparation only: review how to demonstrate raking light on cardboard/foil relief and connect it to exhibition curation.